train project, they want the share of twenty years' profit of the proposed business deal.

The project now seems to be moving ahead, and as of March 2019, the NHSRCL has called in tenders for design, construction, testing and commissioning of a 237-km-long main line for the Mumbai–Ahmedabad High Speed Rail corridor. This is about 47 per cent of the total alignment of 508 km. The work will be undertaken between Zaroli village at the Maharashtra–Gujarat border and Vadodara in Gurjarat, elevated except for one mountain tunnel of about 280 m. There will be twenty-four river crossings and thirty road and canal crossings. The entire alignment will have four stations—Vapi, Bilimora, Surat and Bharuch (all in Gujarat). About 30 per cent of the land required for the project has been acquired, and NHSRCL expects that by the time the tender will be finalized in November 2019, the required land will be available. The corridor of Mumbai-Ahmedabad has been proposed with twelve stations in mind, i.e., Mumbai, Thane, Virar, Boisar, Vapi, Bilimora, Surat, Bharuch, Vadodara, Anand/Nadia, Ahmedabad and Sabarmati, all near major traffic points. Two depots have been proposed on either ends of the corridor—one near Thane and the other near Sabarmati rail depot.

TRAIN 18: VANDE BHARAT EXPRESS—INDIA'S 18-MONTH MARVEL

In 2018, Indian Railways created an iconic semi-high-speed train set code-named Train 18, publicly named the Vande Bharat Express. The sixteen-coach Train 18 designed for a speed of 160 kmph was conceived, designed and developed in a record of time of about 18 months, as against the industry demand of about three-four years by the ICF Chennai at an approximate cost of ₹100 crore, half the price of importing such a train. The train has about 80 per cent Indian origin components. [157]

Sudhanshu Mani, the determined general manager of ICF (now retired), who took over in 2016, said,

> I decided that we must build a modern train set as it would be now or never, at least for me. I learnt that the project had been turned down, primarily because it did not find support of some departments. But I met Railway Board Chairman A.K. Mittal, who agreed and overruled everyone to grant us the sanction within days. We sat down for multiple meetings circa March/April and finalized the concept. And to make sure that the project did not hit any roadblock with change of leadership, we were going to do it well before I retire, that is,